# A Because That Needed Proof

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 4

Lark wondered whether the supply had dried. Nib wondered whether the gate sent water somewhere else. Both ideas could explain a quieter brook from a distance. Neither was proved by sounding sensible. The channel diagram showed where their predictions would differ.

“A convincing because,” Nib announced. “A because we can check,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inlet**

“An if statement makes a prediction we can check,” Lark explained clearly. “If no water reaches the inlet, a direct inlet look should show that. If water is arriving but taking another route, the observation should differ. Our preferred story must wait for the check.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try if, gap, branch. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which observation would help separate the two ideas?” Lark invited gently. “Use the diagram to choose a place where their predictions differ.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **If the inlet is dry, the brook can be dry. If the inlet is wet, look at the gate.**

“What check follows a wet inlet in this plan?” Lark asked gently. “Is an if sentence a result we already observed?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The crew planned a direct inlet and gate inspection from the fixed dry platform. Lark wrote the predictions on separate lines. Nib packed the notebook instead of a repair tool. Before changing anything, they would read how to approach and record the scene without destroying the evidence they came to inspect.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write if beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal now held possibilities and a useful next check. The route was chosen for information, not because either friend's first explanation had won a vote.